

Tuple

Every chord in your
key, one click away.

A chord-grid instrument for Ableton Live: explore, perform
and record harmony in real time — triads, sevenths, ninths,
borrowed chords and secondary dominants, all voiced and
voice-led.



Document

User Manual

Edition

2026 · EN

Online

tuple.live

One screen, all your harmony.

Tuple is not a sequencer. It is a composition and performance tool that lays out **every valid chord** in your key as a playable grid — always visible, never hidden behind a menu.

Pick a key and a scale: Tuple instantly generates the full grid of diatonic chords, column by column, from degree I to degree VII. **Borrowed chords** and **secondary dominants** stay inside the same grid — no wizard, no separate page.

Click a cell (or hit a pad on the Push 2): the chord plays at once, already voiced and voice-led from the previous one. Your hands stay on the music.

KEY IDEA

Tuple outputs **the chord only**. Bass is played on a separate instrument — every voicing stays a coherent chord you can play with one hand.

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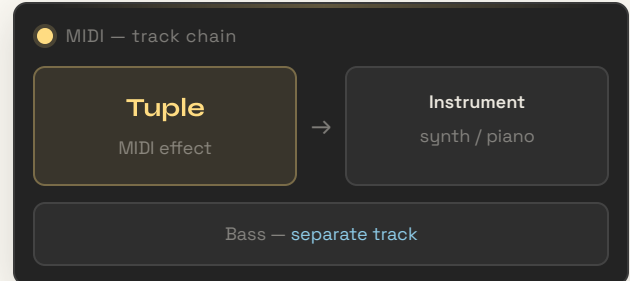
Getting Tuple onto a track.

Requirements

- Ableton Live 11 or 12, Suite edition — or Standard/Intro with the **Max for Live** add-on.
- About **50 MB** of disk space.
- **Push 2** — optional, to play the grid on the pads.
- An **instrument** (synth, piano...) on the same track to hear the chords.

Installation

- 1 Download the latest .amxd archive from tuple.live (or the maxforlive.com page).
- 2 Unzip the archive and **keep all files in the same folder** — the interface loads from these files.
- 3 In Live, drag `tuple.amxd` onto a **MIDI track**.
- 4 Place Tuple **before the instrument** in the MIDI effect chain.
- 5 Arm the track: the chords you play feed the instrument.



Chain order. Tuple → instrument, on the same MIDI track.
Bass lives on its own track.

IMPORTANT

Do not rename or move the files shipped alongside the device: the interface loads from the folder. Keep the bundle intact.

DID YOU KNOW

Tuple outputs the chord only. For bass, add a second track with its own instrument — you keep full control of the low register.

Your first progression in 60 seconds.

- 1 **Set the tonality.** Click **KEY** and **SCALE**, or press **SYNC** to import Live's current scale.
- 2 **Open the grid.** Click **OPEN** to reveal the full window with every chord.
- 3 **Play a chord.** Click a cell in column I — it sounds and its notes appear in the Monitor.
- 4 **Move on.** Jump to columns IV, V, VI... With **Voice Leading** on, transitions stay smooth.
- 5 **Hold the chord.** Toggle **HOLD** to let it ring and free your hands.
- 6 **Record.** Arm the track, hit record, and perform the grid live.

A progression to start with

In **C Major**, try the classic I - V - vi - IV:

C → **G** → **Am** → **F**

Then move up one row to switch to sevenths (CM7 · G7 · Am7 · FM7): the grid stacks richness vertically, from simplest to most colorful.

PERFORMANCE TIP

The **BORROWED** column (far right) adds color and tension without leaving the key: drop a bVII or a V/vi into the middle of a diatonic progression.

SHORTCUT

Instead of setting KEY/SCALE by hand, put Tuple on a track whose Live scale is already defined, then press SYNC.

The control strip.

Inside Live's rack, Tuple sits in a compact strip: controls on the left, Monitor on the right. The full grid opens in a second window.

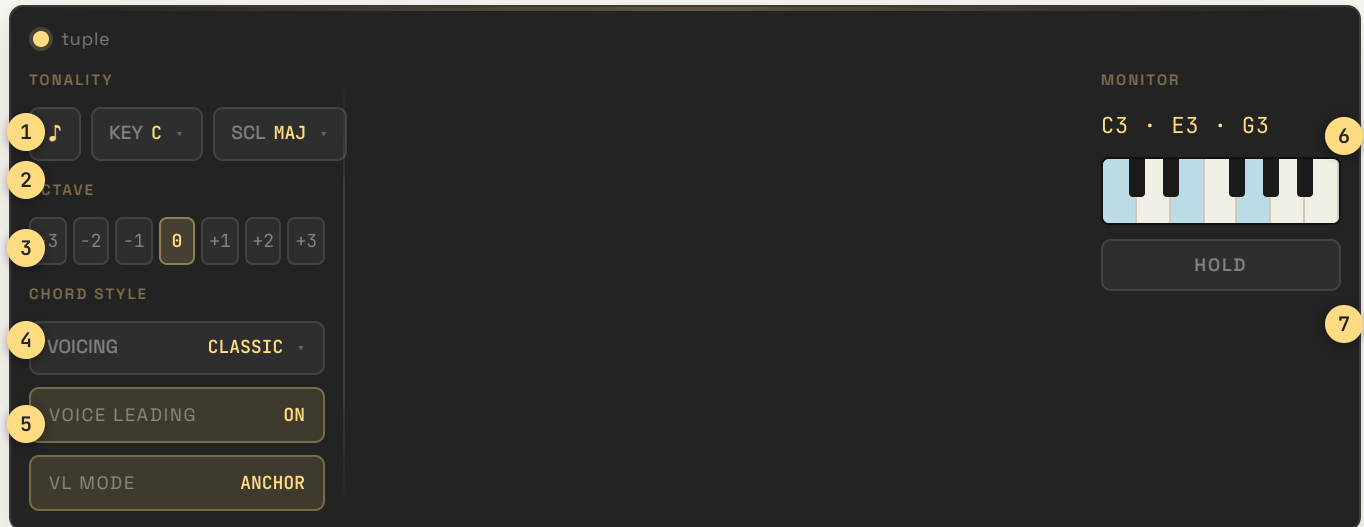


Figure 3.1 — The compact strip as it appears in Live's device rack.

- | | |
|--|---|
| 1 Sync — import key & scale from Live | 2 Key / Scale — root note and scale |
| 3 Octave — transpose the register (-3...+3) | 4 Voicing — note layout (10 modes) |
| 5 Voice Leading + Mode — chord linking | 6 Monitor — played notes + mini-keyboard |
| 7 Hold — sustains the chord (latch) | |

The full window (grid).

One click on **OPEN** unfolds the whole grid: seven degree columns, the **BORROWED** column, and a tool column on the right.

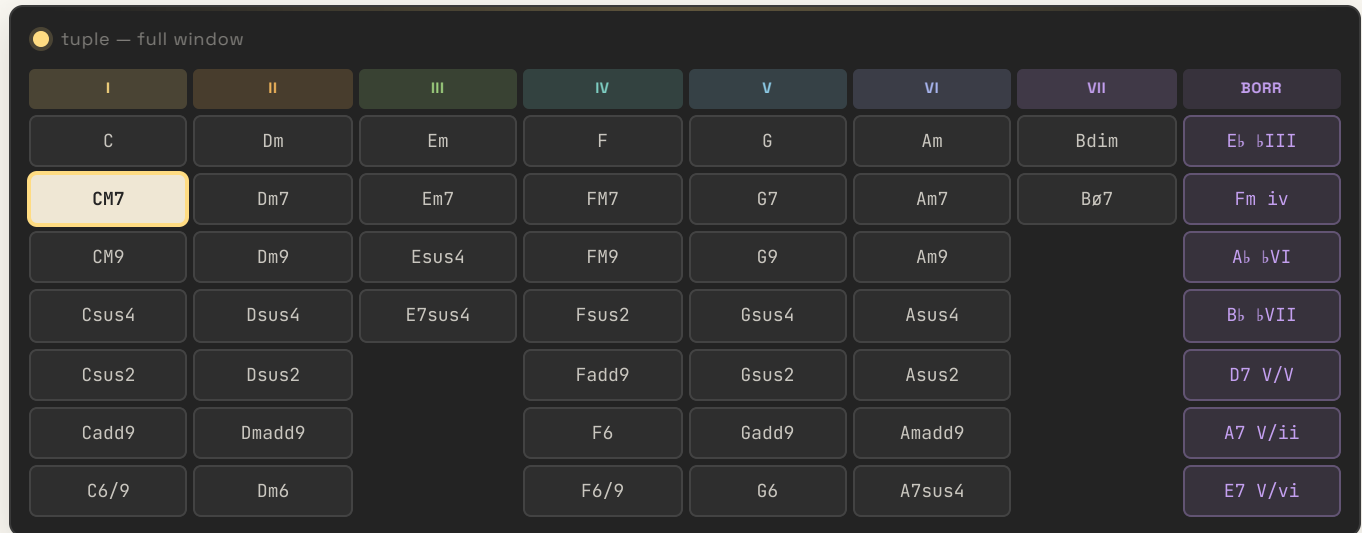


Figure 3.2 — The grid in C Major. Active cell in gold (CM7), borrowed chords in purple.

Reading the grid

- **Columns** = the seven degrees, from I (tonic) to VII (leading tone).
- **Rows** = chord families, ordered from simplest (triad) to most colorful (extensions).
- **Right column** = borrowed chords & secondary dominants.

Tools (right column)

- **Layout** — changes the degree color logic.
- **Push** — grabs the Push 2 pad grid.
- **Always on top · Open/Close** — window management.

Key - Scale - Sync.

The Tonality section defines the harmonic world: the whole grid is recomputed the moment you change root or scale.

Key — the root

Choose one of the twelve chromatic roots, from **C** to **B**. This is the tonal center the degrees I-VII are built around.

Scale — the mode

Seven scales determine the color of the degrees and the available chords:

SCALE	CHARACTER	TYPICAL DEGREE I
Major	Bright, stable — the tonal reference	I maj
Minor	Dark, natural minor (Aeolian)	i m
Dorian	Minor with a major sixth — jazz, modal	i m
Phrygian	Tense minor, minor second — Spanish color	i m
Lydian	Dreamy major, augmented fourth	I maj
Mixolydian	Major with a minor seventh — groove, blues	I 7
Harmonic Minor	Dramatic minor, raised leading tone	i m

Sync — import from Live

The **SYNC** button (tuning-fork icon) reads the key and scale currently set in Live and applies them to Tuple in one click. Ideal when your project already has a scale defined — no need to re-enter it.

If you then change KEY or SCALE by hand, Tuple unsyncs from Live until the next click on SYNC.

WORKFLOW

Set the scale in Live once, then sync all your Tuple devices to it. Change the key in Live and re-sync to transpose a whole session.

Octave - Voicing - Voice Leading.

Four settings, in this order: the register, then how the notes are spread, then how they move from one chord to the next.

Octave

Transposes the whole chord, from -3 to +3 octaves. Direct selection — click the value you want. Handy to seat chords in the right register against bass and melody.

Voicing

Defines how the chord's notes are spread across the register. Ten voicings, from close position to wide pads — see the [reference on p.12](#).

DESIGN RULE

Every voicing is playable with one hand, root included. Only PIANO is deliberately two-handed (low root + right-hand chord).

Voice Leading

When on, **Voice Leading** pulls each new chord close to the previous one: the voices move as little as possible, so transitions become smooth and musical instead of jumpy.

Three linking modes

Anchor	Anchors the voices around a fixed register — stable and predictable.
Relative	Minimal movement relative to the previous chord — the smoothest.
Piano	Pianistic leading, built for the two-handed voicing.

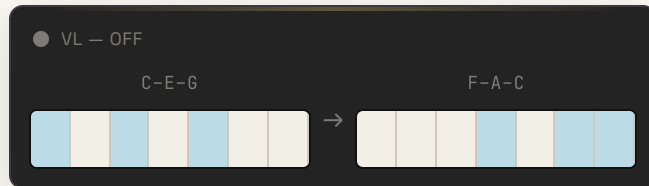
IN PRACTICE

For legato pads, keep VL ON in Relative mode. For repeated rhythmic stabs, turn it off so every chord lands in the same place each time.

What Voice Leading changes.

Without Voice Leading

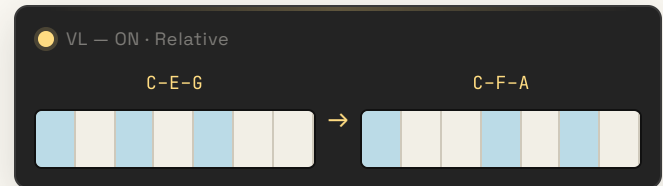
Each chord plays at its root position. The voices jump from one chord to the next.



C → F : the hand "jumps" to the right.

With Voice Leading

The target chord is rearranged to stay near the previous one. The fingers barely move.



C → F : C is shared, only two voices glide by a step.

BY EAR

Voice Leading doesn't change **which** chord you play — only **how** it's laid out. The harmonic function stays identical; what changes is the smoothness of the transition.

Every valid chord, never hidden.

Tuple’s principle: show the maximum number of valid chords for the chosen scale, and keep borrowed chords inside the same grid.

The diatonic degrees

Each column is a degree of the scale, named by its function:

I	Tonic — rest
II	Supertonic
III	Mediant
IV	Subdominant — the lift
V	Dominant — the tension
VI	Submediant — the relative
VII	Leading tone — instability

The rows stack the degree’s chord families, from triad to extensions. A column stops where the scale no longer yields a valid chord — hence the uneven column heights.

The Borrowed column

The last column gathers **borrowed chords** (modal interchange) and **secondary dominants** — colors from elsewhere that enrich the key without leaving it.

IN MAJOR	ROLE
bIII bVI bVII	Borrowed from the parallel minor
iv	Minor subdominant
V/V V/ii V/vi	Secondary dominants

INSTANT COLOR

A minor **iv** right before returning to the **I** is one of the most moving borrowings in pop.

Layout – reading the grid in color.

The **LAYOUT** button cycles through five color logics. The grid stays the same; only the way you read it changes.

I	II	III	IV	V	VI	VII
LOGIC	WHAT THE COLOR ENCODES				USE IT TO...	
 Spectrum	A distinct hue per degree, rainbow-style.				spot the column instantly.	
 Function	Color by function: tonic, subdominant, dominant.				think in tension/rest.	
 Tension	From calm to tense based on the chord's dissonance.				pace the color of a progression.	
 Fifths	Position on the circle of fifths.				compose by fifth motion.	
 Quality	Color by quality: major, minor, diminished, dominant...				sort chords by type.	

ADVICE

Start in **Spectrum** to memorize where the degrees are, then switch to **Function** once you think in tonic / subdominant / dominant.

The ten voicings.

The voicing decides how the notes are spread. All are playable with one hand (except Piano), with the root staying in the chord's register.

VOICING	LAYOUT	BEST FOR
Classic	Close position, notes stacked as tightly as possible.	neutral, all-purpose reference
Piano	Low root + the rest of the chord grouped above (two hands).	piano parts, ballads
Open	Second voice raised an octave — airy chord.	pads, clarity
Spread	Every other voice raised — wide and open.	strings, cinematic pads
House	Chord + a root doubled at the octave (stab).	house, deep house
Prog	Wide prog-techno pad: low + third / high extensions.	prog, melodic techno
Rootless A	No root, structure as is (3-5-7-9).	jazz, when the bass plays the root
Rootless B	No root, lower half raised (7-9-3-5).	alternating jazz comping
Drop 2	2nd voice from the top dropped an octave.	guitar/jazz, balanced sound
Drop 3	3rd voice from the top dropped an octave.	wide voicings, clear bass

REMINDER

Since bass is played separately, the **Rootless** voicings shine: they free up the low end and let the bass breathe.

The chord families.

Each column stacks these families, in the priority order below. The engine only shows a family when the scale makes it valid for that degree.

FAMILY	EXAMPLE LABELS	DESCRIPTION
Triad	maj · m · dim · aug	The three-note chord — always available.
Seventh	M7 · m7 · 7 · dim7 · ø7	Adds the 7th — depth and direction.
Ninth	M9 · m9 · 9	Extends to the major 9th.
Sixth	6 · m6	Soft color, without seventh tension.
Add9	add9 · madd9	Triad + 9th, no 7th — bright.
Sus4	sus4 · 7sus4	Fourth instead of the third — suspension.
Sus2	sus2	Second instead of the third — open.
Six/Nine	6/9 · m6/9	Sixth + ninth — rich and stable.
mMaj7	mMaj7	Minor with major 7th — dramatic color.
7b9 / 7#9	7b9 · 7#9	Altered dominants — strong tension.

ENGINE LOGIC

Tuple detects the real quality of each chord from the scale: the same degree will sound M7, m7 or 7 depending on context, automatically.

See, hold, organize.

Monitor

The right panel shows the **notes of the current chord** in real time (in gold) and highlights them on a **mini-keyboard**. It's instant visual feedback — useful to learn voicings or check the register.

Hold

The **HOLD** button (latch) keeps the chord sounding after you release it: it rings until you play another. Perfect to lay down a pad and keep your hands free for other tweaks.

TIP

With HOLD on, sweep across the degree columns to audition a progression without holding anything — Tuple chains the chords cleanly.

The dual-window workflow

Tuple splits performance into two surfaces:

- The **compact strip** in the rack — controls and Monitor always in view.
- The **full window** with the entire grid, opened via **OPEN**, one click away.

The grid is never shrunk: the rack's limited height would hide it, so it lives in its own window — full access stays immediate.

Always on top

Keep the grid window in front while you work in Live: enable **ALWAYS ON TOP** in the Window group.

RECOMMENDED SETUP

Grid window "always on top" on one side of the screen, Live underneath: you compose at the grid while keeping the arrangement visible.

The grid, under your fingers.

With a Push 2, play the chord grid straight on the pads — one chord per pad, the colors mirroring the screen.

Enable

- 1 Connect the Push 2 and open Tuple's full window.
- 2 Click **PUSH** in the Device section: Tuple grabs the pad grid.
- 3 The pads light up according to the current color logic (Layout).
- 4 Hit a pad: the chord plays, voiced and voice-led, just like on screen.

Push **extends** the grid, it doesn't replace it: columns = degrees I-VII + Borrowed, rows = chord families.



Figure 11.1 — One chord per pad, colors synced with the screen.

NOTE

Push integration is device-specific. It's optional: everything works without Push, via the mouse or MIDI mapping.

Going further.

Workflow tips

- Compose at the grid, record the MIDI, then edit the notes — Tuple seeds the ideas.
- Mix 2–3 borrowings into a diatonic progression for a chorus that “lifts off”.
- Change voicing between verse and chorus without changing the chords.
- Duplicate the track with a different voicing to double / layer textures.

Troubleshooting

No sound	Tuple must be before the instrument, track armed.
Blank interface	Files moved — keep the folder intact, reload the device.
Sync does nothing	Define a scale in Live first, then press SYNC.
Bass too low	Try a Rootless voicing and play bass separately.

FAQ

Is Tuple a sequencer?

No. It’s a tool to choose, explore and perform chords in real time.

Do I need a Push 2?

No, it’s optional. Everything plays via the mouse or MIDI.

Why no bass?

By design: bass is played on a separate track, for full control of the low end.

COMPATIBILITY

Ableton Live 11 / 12 ·
Max for Live

CONTROLLER

Push 2 (optional)

LICENSE

MIT · free

WEB & DEMO

tuple.live

Tuple

Every chord in your key, one click away. Try the demo in your browser before installing.

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